Feedback follow-up

Checking improvement on a new task

Use feedback follow-up to find out whether the learning improved beyond the original correction. A new attempt gives more useful evidence than a rewritten answer alone.

How to do it well

1 Identify the intended improvement. State the knowledge, decision or feature the feedback should change.

2 Prepare a related task. Retain the conceptual demand while altering the example enough to require application.

3 Deliver feedback and action time. Model or prompt the correction and require the student to practise the repaired idea.

4 Collect an independent attempt. Reduce access to the original solution and inspect both answer and reasoning.

5 Return after a delay. Use a later retrieval or application task and decide whether further explanation, rehearsal or support is necessary.

What this sounds like

“You have corrected the worked example. Now close it and try this new case. Explain the decision that prevents the same error.”

Classroom example. After feedback on a misconception, pupils try a fresh question with comparable demand and no visible original solution. The teacher inspects the reasoning, not just the final answer. The learning returns in a later quiz. This separates immediate successful correction from the student’s ability to use the repaired idea independently over time.

Top tips that make the technique work

Plan the new item before feedback. This keeps the improvement focus precise and prevents the follow-up becoming an afterthought.

Keep the demand comparable. An unexpectedly harder question makes it difficult to interpret whether the correction helped.

Change enough to require thinking. A clone with one number swapped may reward imitation.

Revisit after a delay. Immediate success can depend on recent memory of the teacher’s explanation.

Inspect the process. A correct final answer may still hide the original faulty reasoning.

Do and avoid

Do	Avoid
Use independent application on a fresh task.	Counting a copied model as improved understanding.
Record remaining gaps for later teaching.	Never returning to the learning after the feedback lesson.

Further reading

Practitioner guidance; teacher language above is an illustrative BSCS adaptation. Some links support part of this guide rather than the whole technique.

Barton - Correcting in green pen does not work | Barton - Whole-Class Feedback